Lutetium-177 oxodotreotide (Lutathera / PRRT)

NCCP 00642 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Before admission

Confirm SSTR imaging, appointments, recent bloods, hormone medicines and pregnancy precautions. Tell the team about kidney/ heart problems, incontinence, a catheter, childcare or close contact with pregnant people; these may change the practical plan.

STEP 2

Treatment day

The standard NCCP activity is 7.4 GBq by intravenous infusion, usually every eight weeks for four administrations; the specialist may alter, delay or stop treatment. Lutathera runs over approximately 30–40 minutes. A lysine/arginine amino-acid infusion starts 30 minutes beforehand and continues for four hours. An anti-sickness medicine is given at least 30 minutes before the amino acids. The first visit generally includes an overnight stay; later treatments may be day case or overnight. The service confirms your plan.

STEP 3

SSA injections: stop and restart

The NET and nuclear-medicine teams must coordinate the injection plan. Do not translate “about four weeks” into your own date: NCCP specifies 30 days for long-acting SSA and 24 hours for short-acting SSA before PRRT. Restart timing follows the written service plan; it can differ with day-case arrangements.

STEP 4

At home after treatment

Follow individual instructions on distance and time with other people, sleeping arrangements, toilets, body fluids, laundry, work and transport. Restrictions may extend to three weeks for some contacts. Contact the medical physicist before discharge if you cannot follow the plan at home.

STEP 5

Travel and other healthcare

Carry the discharge letter and treatment card, including the date and type of radioactive treatment. Ask about travel and radiation detectors. Tell any healthcare staff you have had PRRT; urgent care must never be delayed because of radiation precautions.

STEP 6

Pregnancy, breastfeeding and fertility

Lutathera can harm an unborn child and may affect fertility. Discuss fertility preservation before treatment. Use effective contraception during treatment and for seven months after the last dose for patients who could become pregnant; men with partners who could become pregnant need contraception during treatment and for four months afterwards. Breastfeeding must stop before treatment; follow specialist advice.

STEP 7

If a visit is delayed

The team decides whether a delayed administration remains suitable and whether activity must change. Do not assume a treatment can automatically proceed at the maximum interval. Continue the blood-test and symptom plan.

STEP 8

Contacts and paperwork

Write the actual NET, PRRT nursing and radiation-protection contacts on the paper plan. Example numbers are not clinical contact lines. Keep the written precautions and urgent hormone-symptom instructions with the discharge letter.

STEP 9

The Irish service’s scan appointments

The detailed Irish leaflet describes three radiation-assessment scans on separate days in the first week after the first infusion, starting the next day, and one scan after later infusions. It also describes CT or MRI between the second and third infusions and after the course. These are service arrangements to confirm on your appointment sheet, not a universal timetable for every NET.

STEP 10

Extra blood tests after the course

NCCP specifies four-weekly blood tests for at least three months, then three-monthly for the following year. The Irish service leaflet also describes fortnightly tests for eight weeks immediately after the final infusion. Your written discharge plan may therefore require more frequent early tests; follow that plan and ask the service to resolve any mismatch.

STEP 11

Paper radiation instructions for home

Before discharge, obtain a paper copy with the exact end date for each restriction. The Irish leaflet includes daily bathing, careful handwashing, sitting to pass urine and separate washing of body-fluid-soiled laundry in the first week. Ask for specific handling instructions for pads, incontinence or a catheter. Sleeping, travel, work and contact limits differ: examples include separate beds from a partner for 14 days and sleeping apart from pregnant people or children for three weeks. Your medical physicist’s personal instructions take precedence.

STEP 12

Carry the official radiation card too

The medical physicist supplies a radiation-treatment card to carry for the time stated. The SACTCheck wallet card is an additional treatment record and does not replace that official card, the discharge letter or the radiation-safety plan.

Sources: NCCP 00642 v2 · current Irish Lutathera regimen. Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.